



**MET ASIAN MANAGEMENT
DEVELOPMENT CENTRE**

**A LIVE PROJECT REPORT ON
BRAND ASSET VALUATOR AND BRAND PERSONALITY STUDY OF COTTON KING**

SUBMITTED BY:

HAJI RAYYAAN TAJ

(DATA ANALYST)

ROLL NO: 2440

PGP EMBA BA (2024 - 2026)

MARKETING & BUSINESS ANALYTICS

MUMBAI EDUCATION TRUST

ASIAN MANAGEMENT DEVELOPMENT CENTRE,

BHUJBAL KNOWLEDGE CITY,

BANDRA RECLAMATION, BANDRA, MUMBAI – 400050

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Lastly, we take immense pride in expressing our gratitude to our families for their continuous support and encouragement during the pandemic, which motivated us to step out and conduct the survey successfully.

Prof. Anand Limaye

Cotton King Authority

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Young and Rubicam (Y&R) created the Brand Asset Valuator - BAV Model, which is a model of brand equity. It helps the brands understand its marketplace opportunities and the type of risk that goes with the brand.

BAV provides comparative measurements of the brand equity of thousands of brands across hundreds of different categories based on research with nearly 200,000 consumers in 40 countries. According to the BAV Model, brand equity has four main components or pillars.

These pillars measure a brand's strength and stature.

1. **Differentiation** measures the degree to which a brand is seen as different from others.
2. **Relevance** measures the breadth of a brand's appeal.
3. **Esteem** measures how well the brand is regarded and respected.
4. **Knowledge** measures how familiar and intimate consumers are with the brand

Instrument of Data Collection	Questionnaire
Sample size	1000 + 200 (Brand Personality)

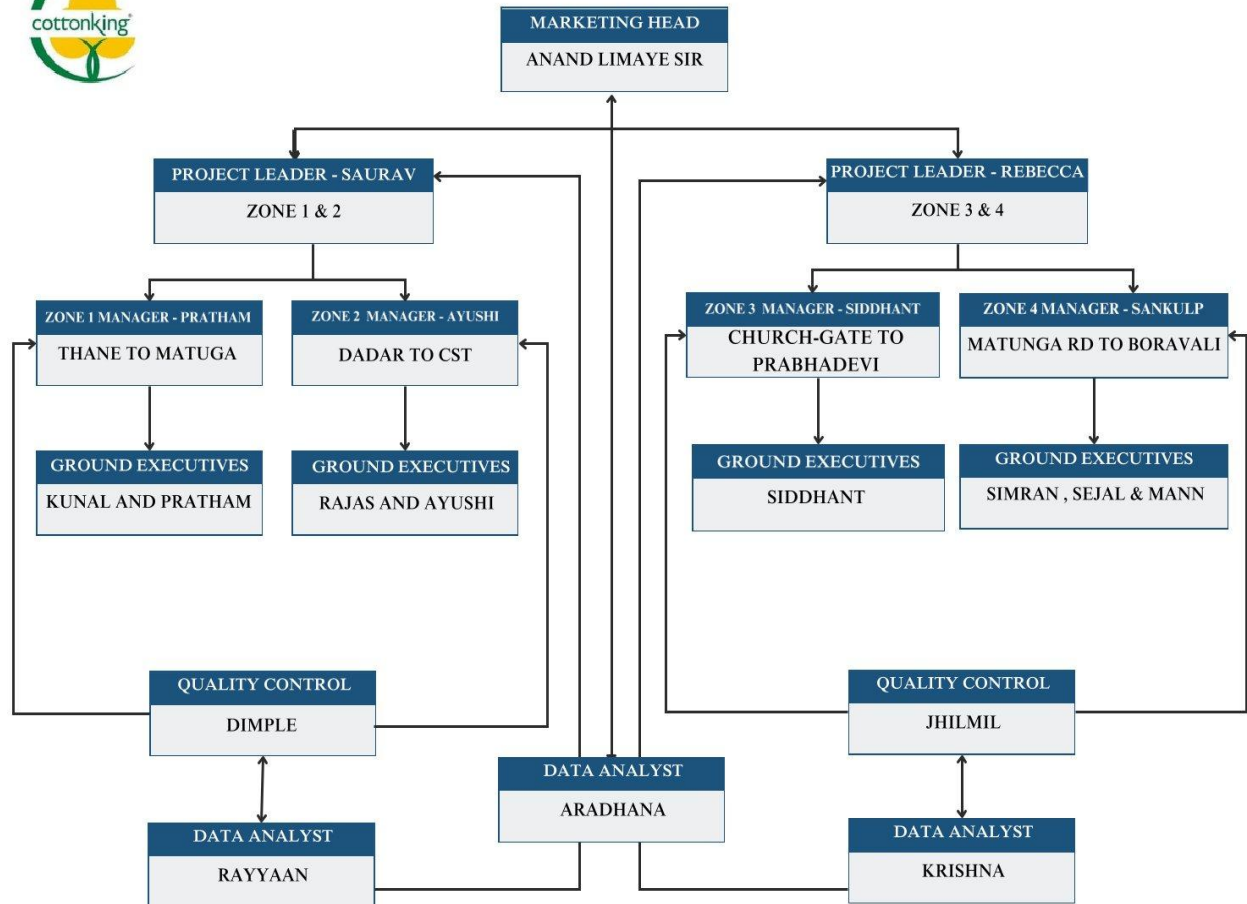
ZONAL DISTRIBUTION



COTTON-KING

Sample size 1000

Each Zone 250



BRIEF HISTORY OF COTTON KING

Cotton King - Brand synonymous with Success, Trust, Quality and Excellence. The brand's three pillars are 100 percent cotton, maximum cotton variety, and value for money for its clients. Cotton King is a unique brand that was founded in 1996. Cotton King prioritizes the consumer with a clear vision and laser-like focus. Cotton King also has a large selection of formal shirts, pants, T-shirts, jeans, and casual shirts.

Cotton King assures that all garments are created under one roof, from fabric cutting to finishing, at its ultramodern manufacturing factory in Baramati, near Pune. Cotton King has the rare distinction of being both a manufacturer and a retailer. Cotton King is able to respond quickly to market changes, reduce costs, and maintain superior quality as a result of this. Cotton King is also one of the most well-known brands in terms of print, radio, and television advertising campaigns. Cotton King believes in innovation and strives to provide its clients with completely new products each season, such as the Cool Slubz, Aero soft, and Easy2Iron shirts that were recently introduced. Cotton King is the heartthrob of cotton lovers.

The success story

Started from just a handful of retail stores till a 100s now Cotton King as a brand has come a long way and has made its position as “The King of Cotton ready-mades” but this position is obtained by Cotton King due to some of the factors which make Cotton King the brand it is today Cotton King’s main ultramodern manufacturing factory is located at Baramati where all the process of making garments is carried on. From the process of selection and approval of cotton fabric till the ready-made garment is finally made all the processes are carried on at the same location.

There are some factors which add on to why Cotton King is a quality and consumer satisfaction

Brand and the factors are as follows

Quality testing

As shared by the Director of Cotton King Mr. Kunal Marathe, the quality of the cotton fabrics is being tested with help of various methods like view test and burn tests just to ensure that the cotton fabrics that come to Cotton King are 100% cotton and have a great quality. Providing great quality garments has been one of the major goals of Cotton King

Consumer Satisfaction

One of the main visions and aim of Cotton King as a brand and its employees is to ensure that the consumer is completely satisfied with the brand and the quality of garments the company produces, and that is one of the reasons that all the garments are made with a lot of details as per the customer needs. Consumer satisfaction is something the company and its employees all truly believe in.

The variety factor

Mr. Marathe also believes that the leadership position that Cotton King has today for cotton garments is also because variety is one of the factors and believes it helps them grow. Different types of varieties are available at Cotton King with different price ranges in accordance with the consumer's pocket. It means having a pure cotton readymade garment in your style at your price.

Efficient Supply Chain

Mr. Marathe further explains how important it is to have an efficient supply chain management in order to produce and deliver such top quality and variety garments to the customers. In order to make the Supply chain easier for them a warehousing system has been established which is approximately 20000 sq. ft. area and this system helps them deliver the goods within 12 hours of the order period.

Promotion of Social Development

Alongside the success of the Brand Cotton King also believes that it is important to promote and bring in social development changes in the society. Around 70% of the population working for Cotton King are women hence promoting social development too.

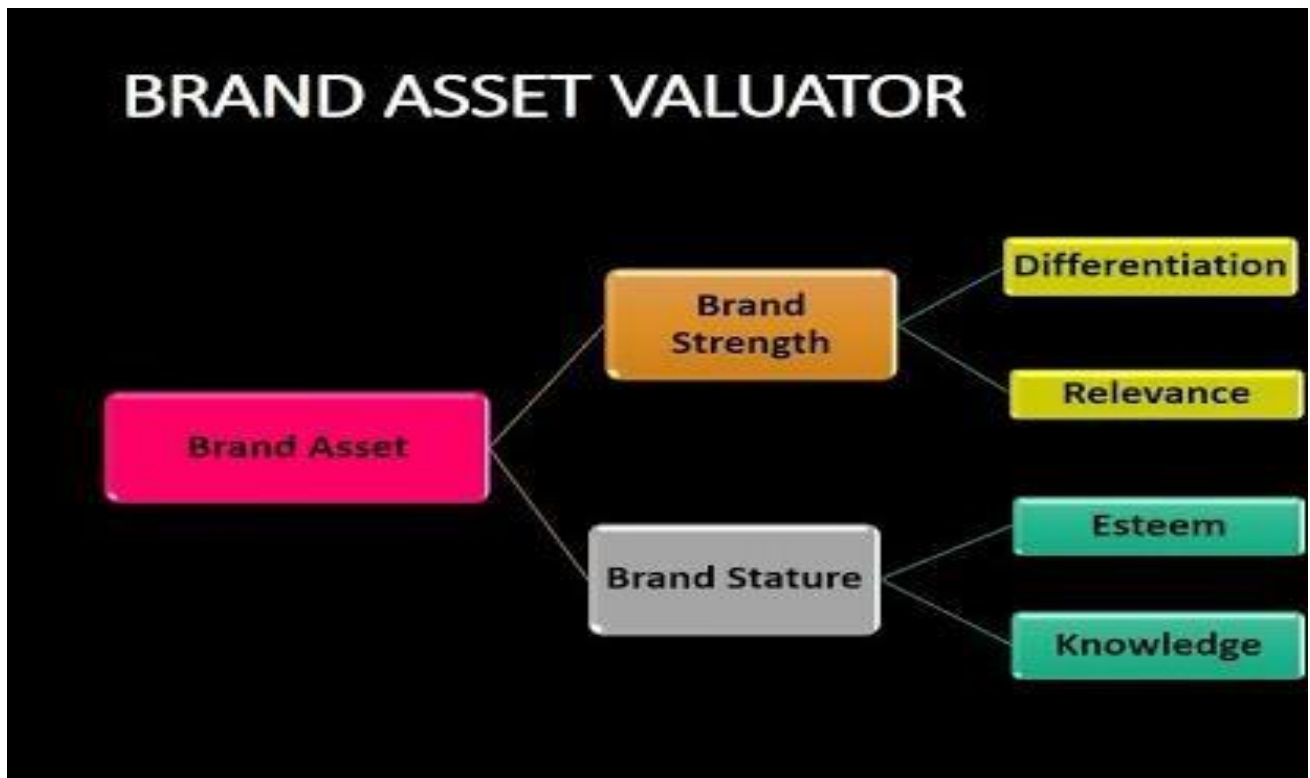
The Environment factor

Water saving and recycling is very important and one of the major reasons for environmental issues. Cotton King ensures that all the water after it is used for washing of the fabrics is recycled and reused with the help of ETP system so there is no wastage of water.

Usage of advanced technology and machinery

One of the main reasons for the High-quality production of the garments is also the usage of highly advanced German and Japan oriented technologies which help in production of the garments in a more efficient way. These are some of the factors that make Cotton King truly the brand it is today. Cotton King enjoys a good position and goodwill in the market when it comes to cotton garments and these factors are the reasons Cotton King is successful and truly stands for its name.

WHAT IS BAV?



Young and Rubicam (Y&R) created the Brand Asset Valuator - BAV Model, which is a model of brand equity. BAV provides comparative measurements of the brand equity of thousands of brands across hundreds of different categories based on research with nearly 200,000 consumers in 40 countries.

According to the BAV Model, brand equity has four main components or pillars.

1. Differentiation

It is a brand's ability to differentiate itself from its competition. Differentiation is made up of three parts. These are the ones. The term "different" refers to how the brand's offering differs from that of its competitors. The term "unique" alludes to the brand's excellence and captures its identity. It has more to do with the brand's trustworthiness, authenticity, and uniqueness of concept. The term "distinctive" alludes to a brand's worthiness.

2. Relevance

This is a crucial driver of a brand's penetration since it refers to how closely consumers can relate to the brand's offering.

3. Esteem

This relates to the brand's image among consumers. Whether a brand is well-known or not, and whether it lives up to its promises, all of these factors contribute to the brand's esteem.

4. Knowledge

This relates to how well-informed or aware people are about a particular brand. This is critical in developing a brand and ensuring that consumers understand what the brand stands for and the implicit message it sends to them. $\text{Brand Strength} = \text{Differentiation} \times \text{Relevance}$. The logic is that a brand must have both the characteristics in order to be strong.

Brand Stature

$\text{Brand stature} = \text{esteem} \times \text{knowledge}$ Esteem and knowledge complete the hierarchy and combine to form the brand stature construct. According to the BAV model, it's important to measure how differentiation, relevance, esteem and knowledge are related to one another so we can determine the brand strength and stature.

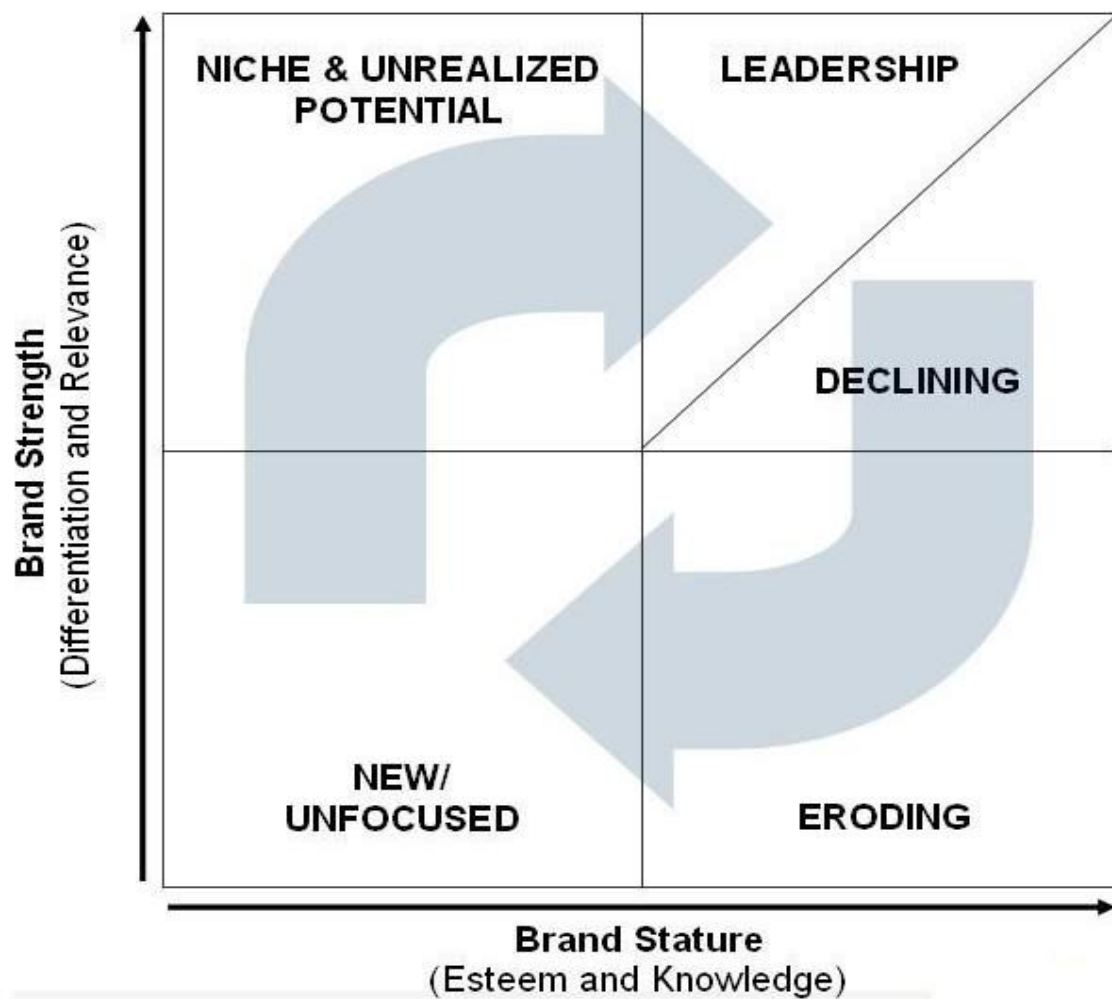
Here are the dynamics for BAV:

- **Differentiation is higher than relevance:** When your brand is different, consumers are curious as to why and want to learn more. This can attract customers, get them to explore the brand, and find out if it is relevant to them.
- **Relevance is higher than differentiation:** When your brand is more relevant to consumers than it is different from other brands, it loses its appeal and ability to attract customers. You're now competing solely on relevancy, which means customers will only buy your product or service if it's cheap or convenient.
- **Esteem is higher than knowledge:** Consumers who hold a high regard for your brand respect and seek it because it is so well-known. Consumers want to buy your product or service to find out why it has such a high level of customer loyalty.
- **Knowledge is higher than esteem:** When customers claim to know everything there is to know about your firm, it can cause problems, especially if they believe they know negative things about it. Consumers who believe they don't need to learn anything else about your brand have already made up their minds about it, which suggests they're more interested in learning about your competitors than you.

THE POWER GRID:

This approach plots brands on a "Power Grid" that reflects the Strength and Stature of each brand. The Power Grid establishes the strategic approach by identifying a brand's strength and weakness. We have brand strength relevance and differentiation on the vertical axis, and brand stature esteem and knowledge on the horizontal axis.

Brand Strength



To be successful, a brand must have both differentiation and relevance.

Brand Stature

Brand Stature is a combination of esteem and knowledge and reflects current brand performance. Esteem increases before knowledge for snacks, soda and other impulse purchase products. Further As indicated in the diagram below, diagnostic information can be gathered using a stature-by-strength diagnostic architecture known as a power grid.

There are four quadrants in this grid

- 1st Quadrant- In the Quadrant 1, the brand is either a new brand that has just entered the market or an old stagnant brand with no apparent focus. The brand in quadrant 1 has a lower brand stature and brand strength. The quadrant is split into two sections. a) A brand that isn't focused is likely to become stagnant; b) A new brand is more likely to be distinguished by its lack of differentiation, relevance, respect, and knowledge. This might be enhanced to take the brand into the second quadrant.
- 2nd Quadrant- In Quadrant 2, the company hasn't yet been able to fulfil the full potential of its brand or the brand's role in a market segment. The brand strength in this quadrant is distinguished by differentiation and some brand attributes that are relevant to consumer demands, but the brand stature is low; nonetheless, the brand revenue in this quadrant, while low, has the potential to grow in the future.
- 3rd Quadrant- in Quadrant 3, this brand earns a lot of money and has a lot of promise for future expansion. However, the third quadrant is separated into two portions, one of which is the leader and the other is the diminishing brand leader. As a result of building the past successful brand, the decreasing leader in this brand results in high sales marked by high esteem and knowledge, but it is currently in a position of low differentiation and relevance, implying that the company needs to do some research-based innovation to stay relevant.
- 4th Quadrant- In Quadrant 4, the brand's last quadrant reads "Danger," indicating that its potential is diminishing. This quadrant's brands have been unable to sustain their relevance. If left ignored, their stature will begin to deteriorate. These brands will lose Esteem and may eventually evaporate from consumers' attention unless actions are done to stimulate uniqueness and relevance.

Data Collection

A Questionnaire was prepared to study the Brand Asset valuator of the Brand It comprises of 12 questions, each highlighting one of the four dimensions of the BAV model i.e.: Differentiation, Relevance, Esteem and knowledge The questionnaire was distributed amongst a sample size of 1000 people. The data collected was quantitative data as it purely includes Numeric Data The type of Data technique used is Primary Data as it includes the Data collected by students themselves with help of others and not secondary data as there is no use of any other data that was previously found by somebody else. After collecting the entire data, we can measure the Brand Asset Valuator of the company based on the following

Instrument of Data Collection	Questionnaire
Sample Size	1000+200 (Brand Personality)
Location	Thane to Matunga, Dadar to CSMT, Churchgate to Prabhadevi, Matunga Road to Borivali

Questionnaire of Cotton King: BAV and Brand Personality

The questionnaire for this study consisted of two key parts: the Brand Asset Valuator (BAV) section and the Brand Personality section. The BAV questionnaire focused on the four pillars of brand equity: Differentiation, Relevance, Esteem, and Knowledge, where respondents rated Cotton King on attributes such as uniqueness, market relevance, quality perception, respect, familiarity, and emotional connection. This quantitative framework enables a multi-dimensional analysis of Cotton King's brand strength and stature in the competitive menswear market.

The Brand Personality section assessed the emotional and symbolic traits associated with Cotton King. Based on established scales like Jennifer Aaker's, respondents selected personality adjectives such as sincerity, excitement, competence, sophistication, and ruggedness that best described their perception of the brand. This part of the questionnaire helped reveal Cotton King's persona relative to consumer expectations and competing brands. The surveys were conducted face-to-face across four Mumbai zones using structured Likert scales, complemented by detailed graphs visualizing consumer responses for each attribute and personality trait.

THE FOLLOWING ARE THE QUESTIONNAIRE USED IN THIS STUDY:

Name:		Age:25-45	
Occupation:	Income (p.a):		
Mobile No:	Email ID:		

KNOWLEDGE

Q1. What is your favourite brand in the Men's clothing category?

Answer:

Q2. Identify the logo of the brand shown below?



Q3. Which men's clothing brands always deliver what you want?

Answer:

ESTEEM

Q4. Which brand do you trust from the below mentioned brands? On a scale of 1 to 5

(1-Not Aware, 2-No Trust, 3-Low Trust, 4-Trusted, 5- Highly Trusted)

Brands	Peter England	Van Heusen	Raymond	Allen Solly	Cotton King
1-5					

Q5. Which brand do you trust the most for cotton shirts/trousers? On a scale of 1 to 5

(1-Not Aware, 2-No Trust, 3-Low Trust, 4-Trusted, 5- Highly Trusted)

Brands	Peter England	Van Heusen	Raymond	Allen Solly	Cotton King
1-5					

Q6. Would you Gift/recommend the brand cotton king to a friend? On a scale of 1 to 5

(1- No recommendation and 5- Highly Recommended)

1-5	
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RELEVANCE

Q7. Which brands do you associate the following attributes listed below? Kindly (✓) your answers.

Attributes	Peter England	Van Heusen	Raymond	Allen Solly	Cotton King
Value for Money					
Comfortable					
Colour					
Pattern/Design					
Durability					
Fitting					

Q8. Kindly indicate your degree of agreement for the statement given “COTTON KING - The king of cotton ready-mades”. Rate on a scale of 1 to 5

(1- Strongly disagree, 2- Disagree, 3- Neutral, 4- Agree, 5- Strongly agree)

Brand	Cotton King
1-5	

Q9. If you consider Cotton King as a brand, which of the attributes you can relate to with the brand. Kindly (✓) your answers.

Attributes	Value for money	Comfortable	Colour	Pattern/Design	Durability	Fitting

DIFFERENTIATION

Q10. Do you think Cotton King is unique in terms of style? On a scale of 1 to 5

(1- Definitely No, 5- Definitely Yes)

1-5	
------------	--

Q11. Do you think Cotton King is unique in terms of quality? On a scale of 1 to 5

(1- Definitely No, 5- Definitely Yes)

1-5	
------------	--

Q12. Do you think Cotton king stands out as compared to other brands? On a scale of 1 to 5

(1- Definitely No, 5- Definitely Yes)

1-5	
------------	--

BRAND PERSONALITY:

Brand Personality

**Q1. What does the word 'Cotton' mean to you when you think of the brand Cotton King?
(Select only one)**

- ☐ Down to Earth
- ☐ Honest
- ☐ Wholesome
- ☐ Cheerful
- ☐ Up-to-Date
- ☐ Reliable
- ☐ Intelligent
- ☐ Charming

**Q2. If Cotton King would talk to you, what tone do you think suits it the most?
(Select only one)**

- ☐ Serious and professional
- ☐ Warm and friendly
- ☐ Confident and bold
- ☐ Playful and funny
- ☐ Kind and caring

Q3. Which celebrity personality would you associate with the brand Cotton King if it were a person?

(Select only one)

- ☐ Rajkumar Rao
- ☐ Sonu Sood
- ☐ Ritesh Dekhmukh
- ☐ Pankaj Tripathi
- ☐ Ashok Saraf
- ☐ Manoj Bajpayee
- ☐ Ajinkya Rahane
- ☐ Nana Patekar

KEY FINDINGS

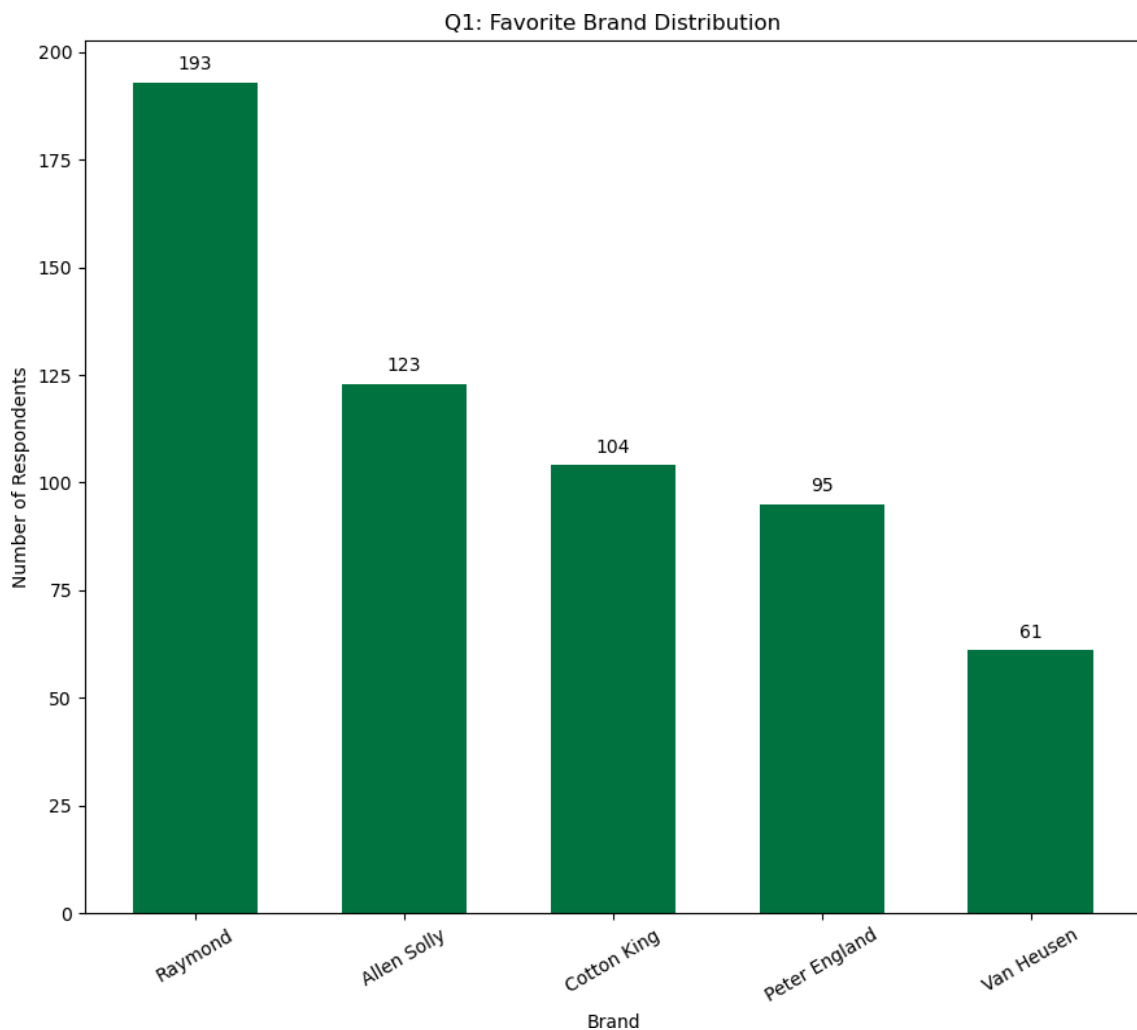
Brand Knowledge

This section explores the first pillar of the Brand Asset Valuator (BAV) model: Brand Knowledge. This dimension captures consumer awareness, familiarity, and recognition of Cotton King relative to competing menswear brands. Strong brand knowledge is essential for building deeper consumer connections beyond simple awareness.

Brand Knowledge Questionnaire

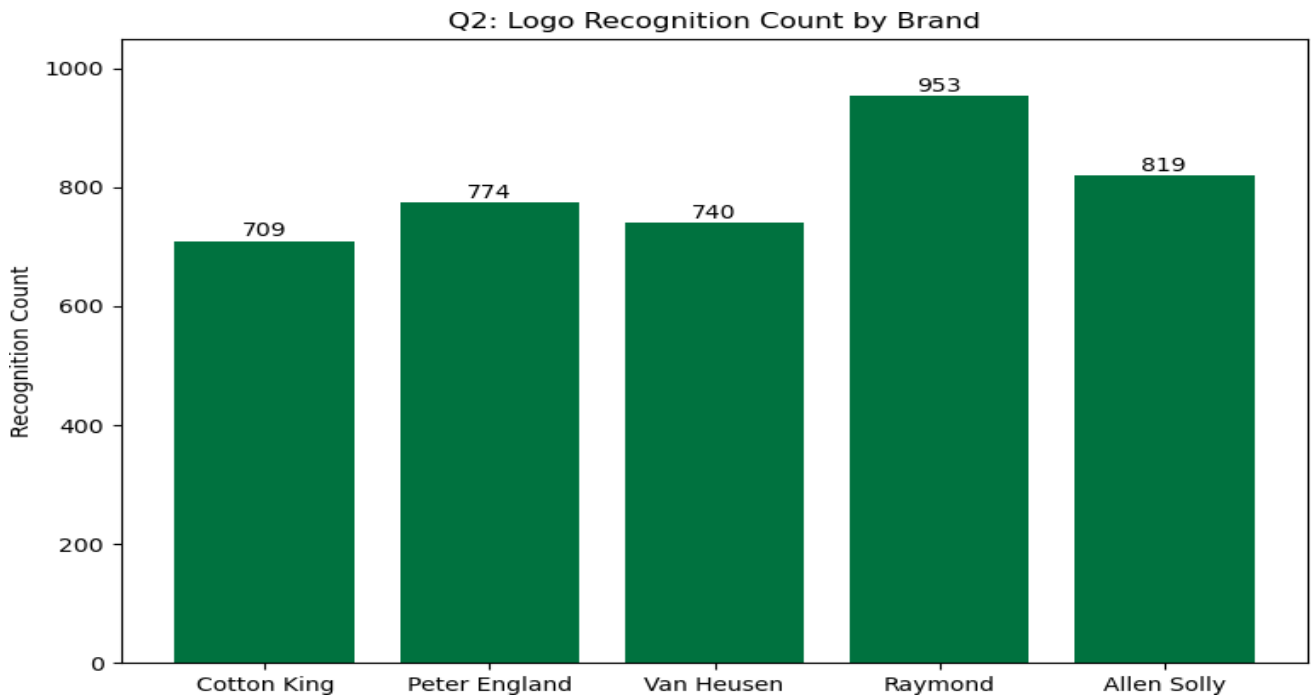
1. What is your favourite brand in the Men's clothing category?

This question assesses top-of-mind brand recall and reveals preference distribution across leading menswear brands.



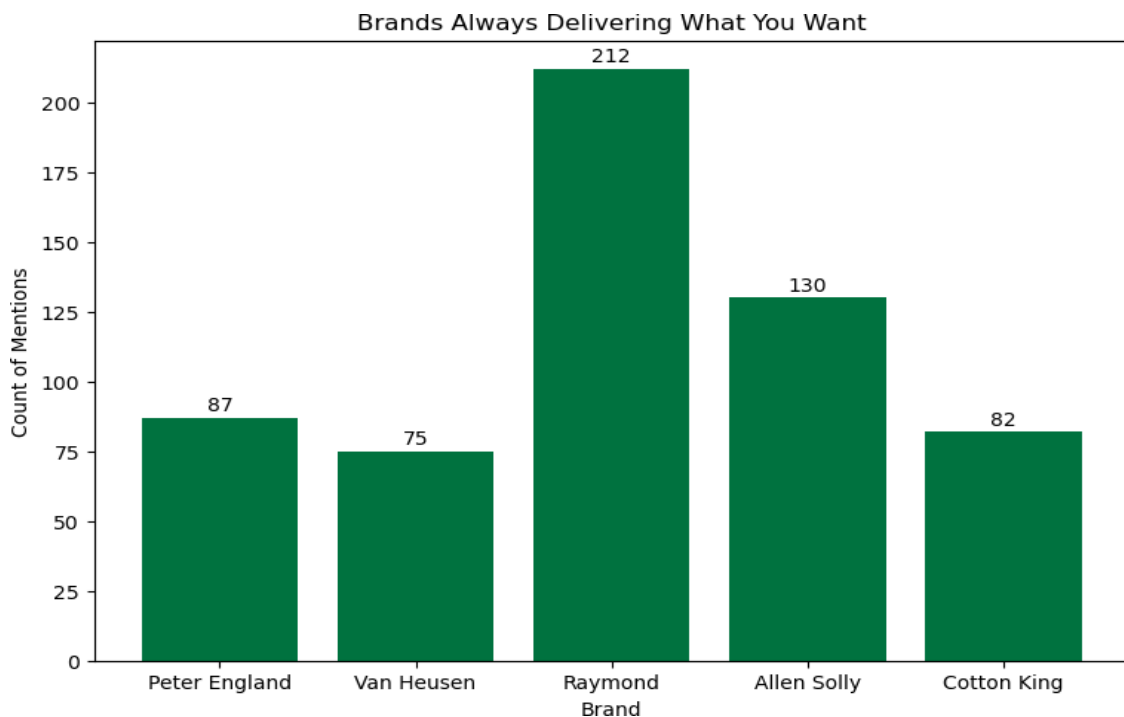
2. Identify the logo of the brand shown below?

This visual test measures familiarity with core brand identities.



3. Which men's clothing brands always deliver what you want?

Here, respondents identified brands seen as reliably meeting expectations for quality, design, and service.



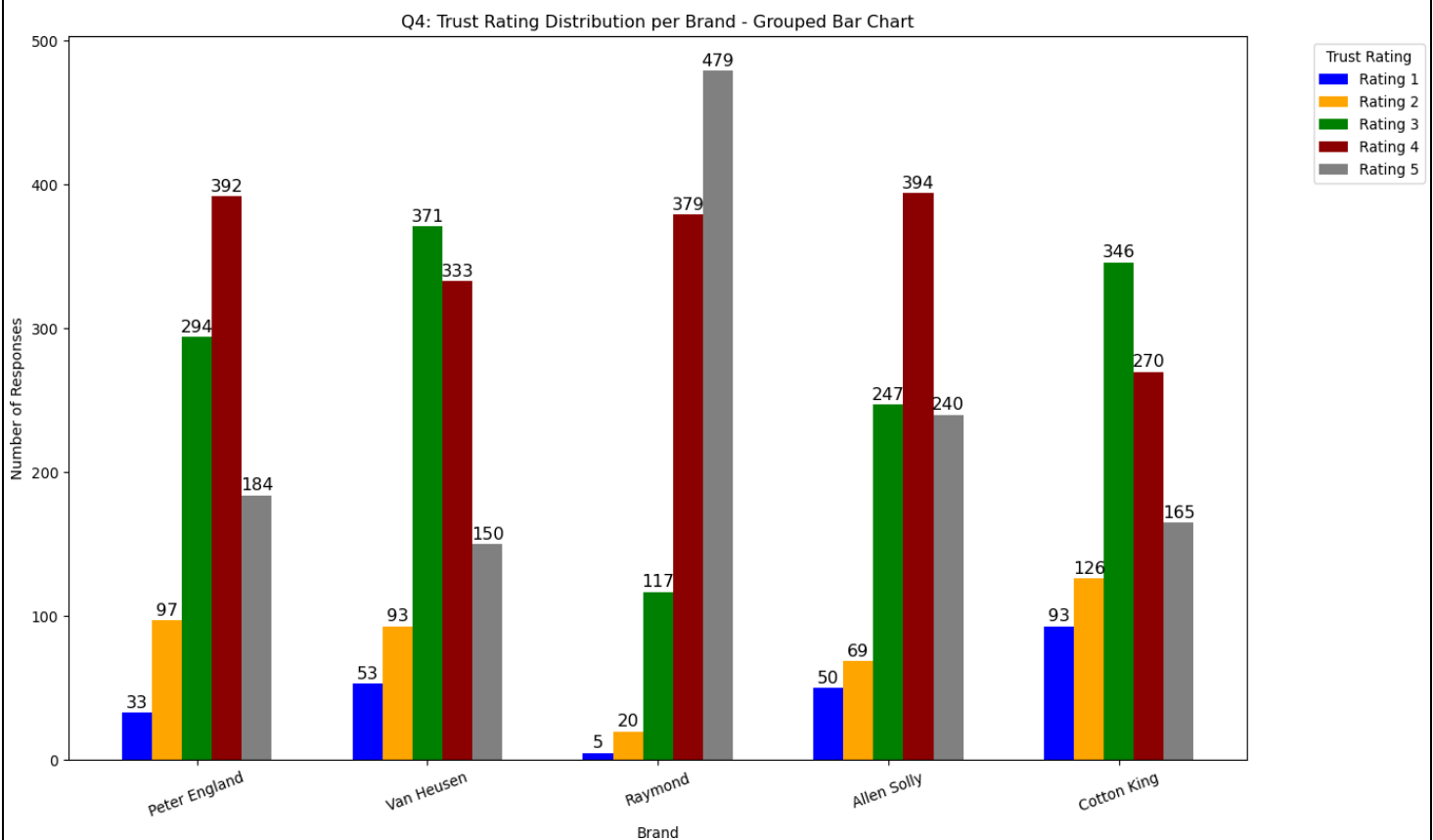
Brand Esteem

The second BAV pillar, Brand Esteem, evaluates consumer trust, perceived respect, and loyalty towards competing menswear brands. Strong esteem signals not only perceived quality but also a brand's ability to inspire confidence and long-term preference among its target audience.

Brand Esteem Questionnaire

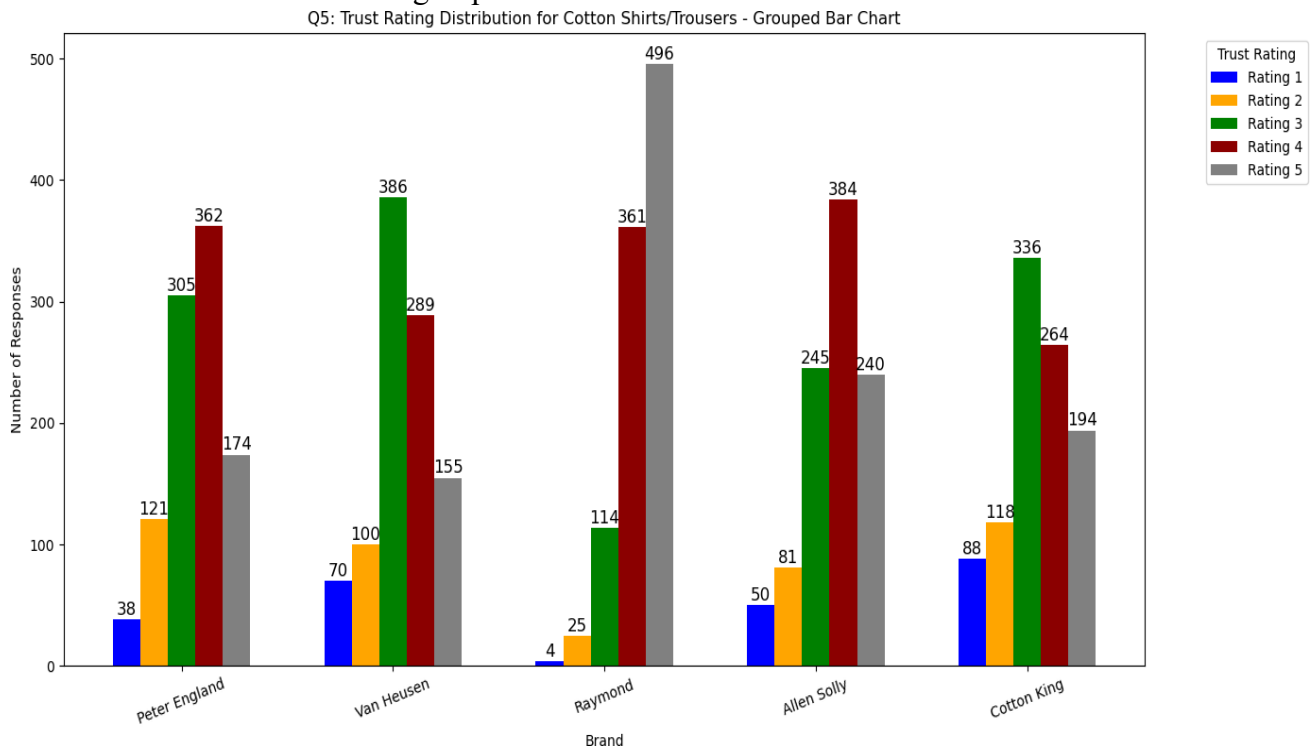
4. Which brand do you trust from the below mentioned brands?

Respondents rated their trust in leading menswear brands on a scale of 1 (Not Aware) to 5 (Highly Trusted). The bar chart below illustrates comparative trust distributions.



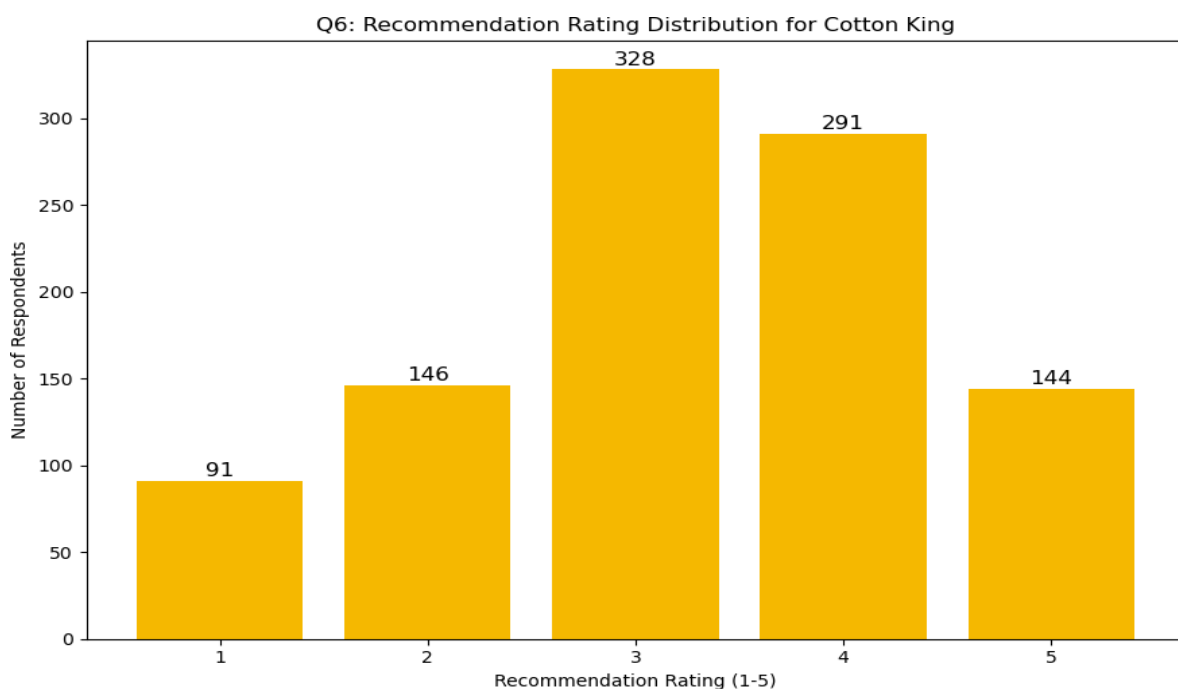
5. Which brand do you trust the most for cotton shirts/trousers?

This question further breaks down trust specific to the cotton apparel category. Distribution across brands is visualized in the next group bar chart.



6. On a scale of 1 to 5, how likely are you to recommend Cotton King?

Here, respondents quantified their likelihood of recommending Cotton King to others, revealing the brand's net promoter strength and referral appeal.



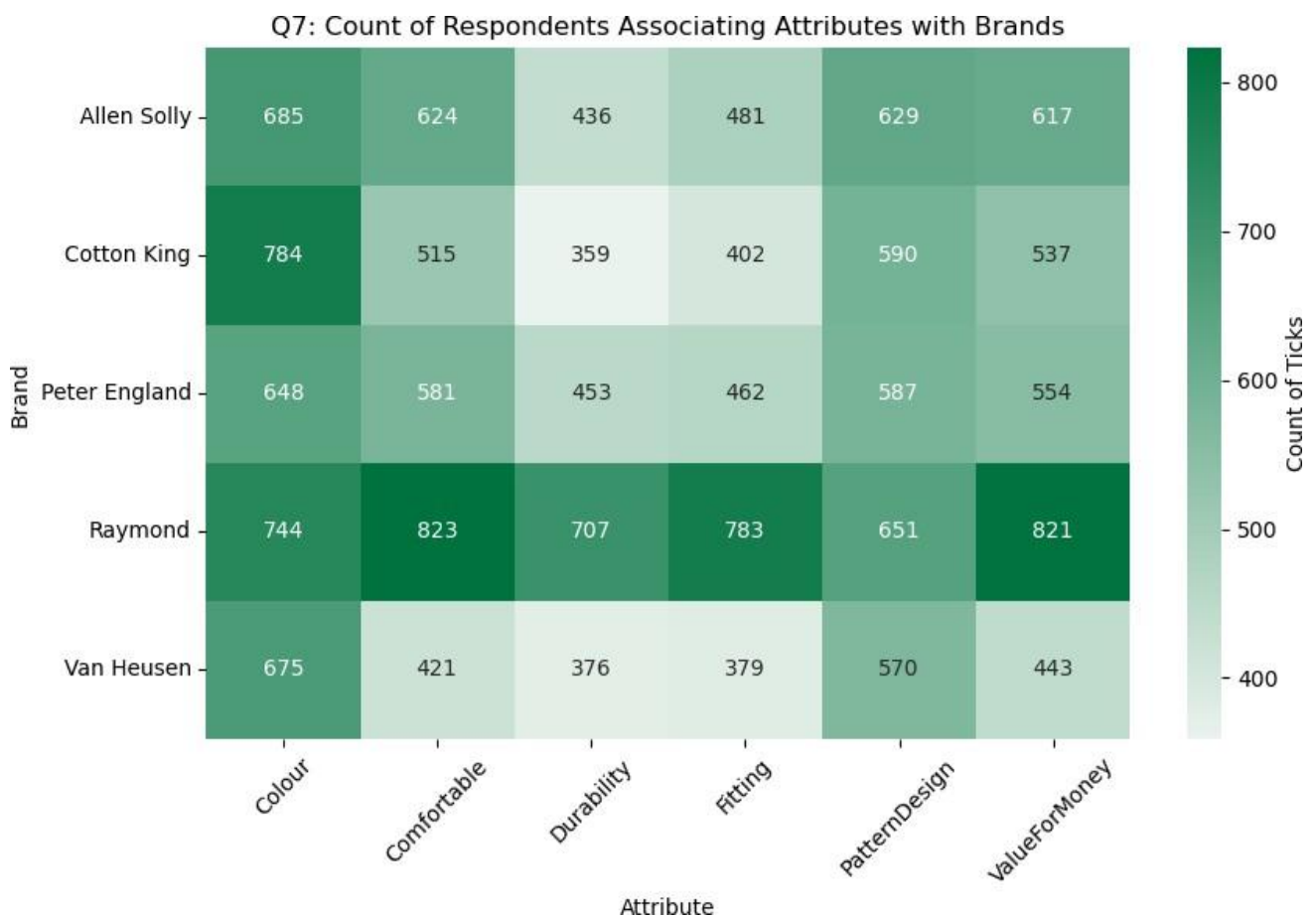
Brand Relevance

The third BAV pillar, Brand Relevance, evaluates how closely Cotton King's attributes and positioning align with consumer needs and preferences. High relevance reflects a brand's ability to stay meaningful, widely adopted, and maintain customer attachment in a competitive market landscape.

Brand Relevance Questionnaire

7. Which brands do you associate the following attributes with? (Value for Money, Comfortable, Color, Pattern/Design, Durability, Fitting):

This heatmap compares the extent to which respondents associate these core attributes with leading brands, highlighting Cotton King's strengths and areas for improvement in perceived relevance.



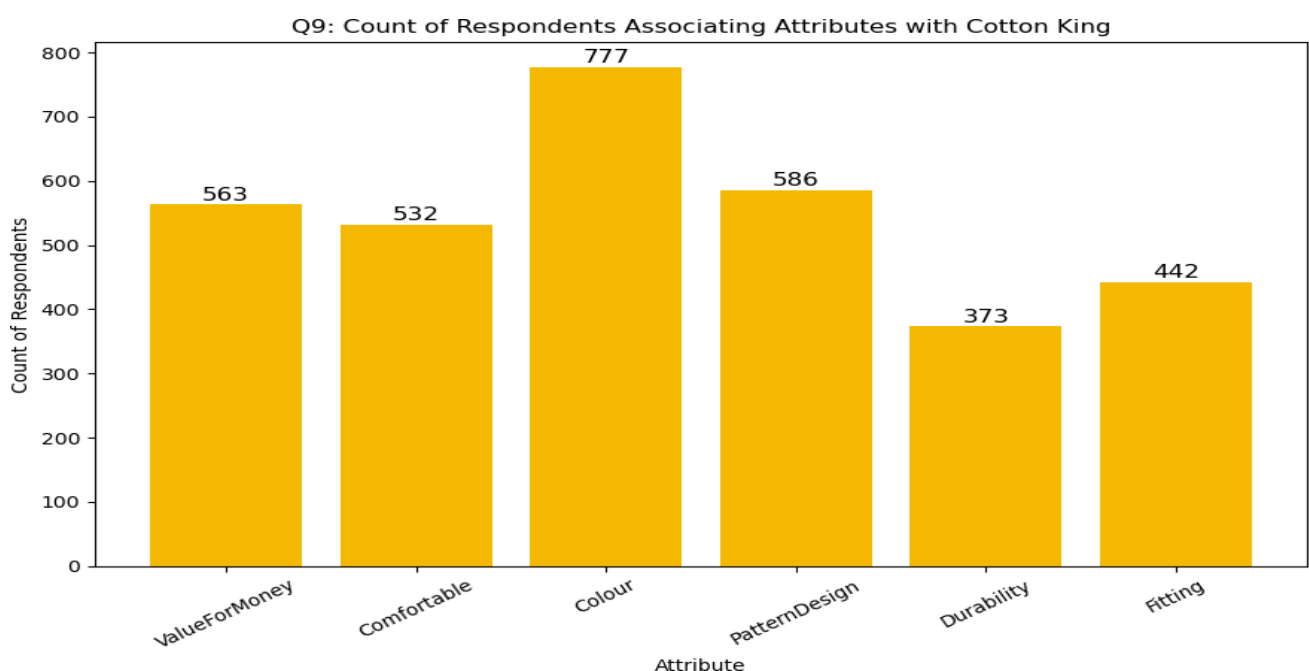
8. Kindly indicate your degree of agreement for the statement “COTTON KING - The king of cotton ready-mades” (1: Strongly disagree, 5: Strongly agree):

Respondent ratings demonstrate perceived alignment with Cotton King’s brand promise and market positioning.



9. If you consider Cotton King as a brand, which of the attributes do you relate to? (Value for Money, Comfortable, Color, Pattern/Design, Durability, Fitting):

This attribute association bar chart reveals the specific qualities consumers most strongly connect to Cotton King.



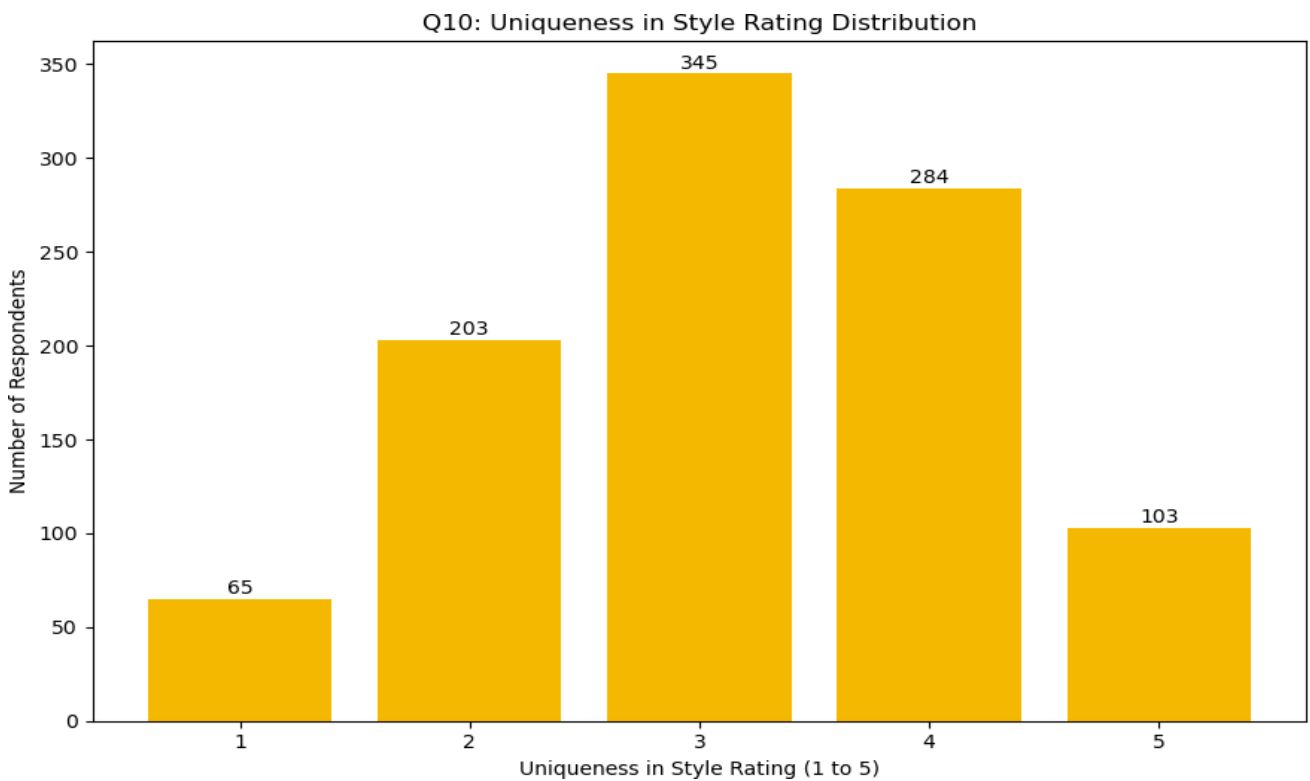
Brand Differentiation

Brand Differentiation assesses the extent to which Cotton King stands out for its style, quality, and overall market presence, relative to key competitors. Substantial differentiation is vital for cultivating brand desire, loyalty, and long-term growth.

Brand Differentiation Questionnaire

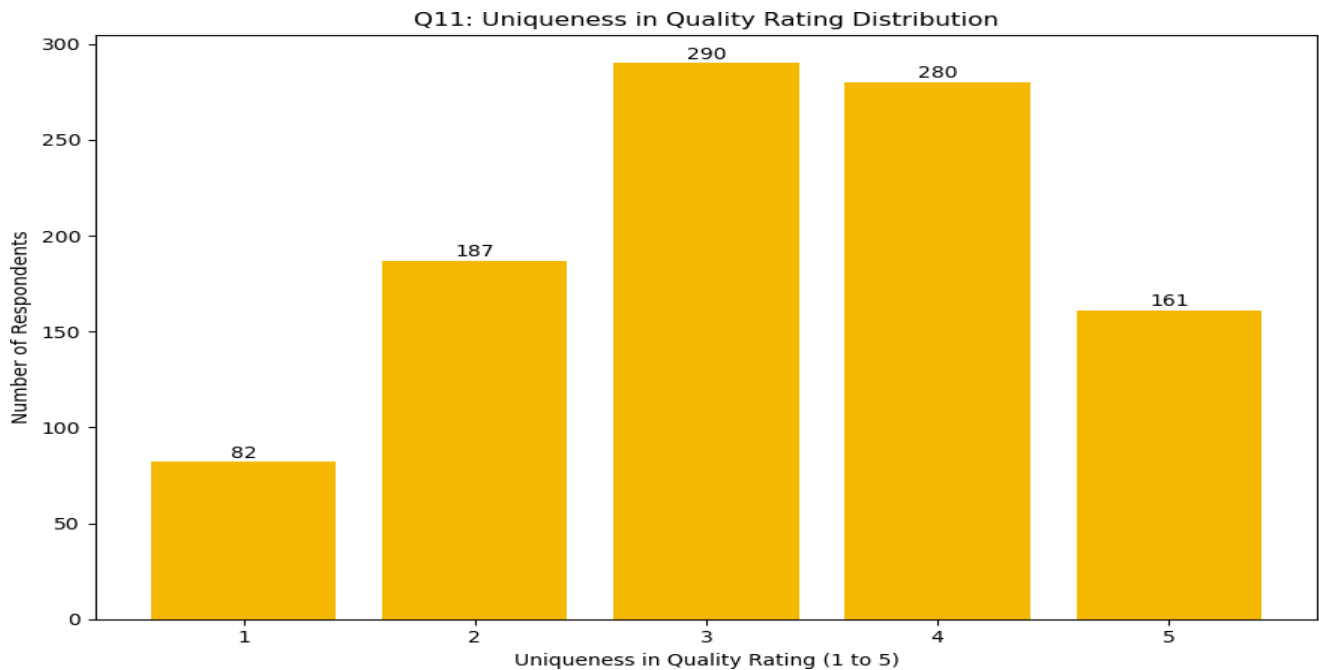
10. Do you think Cotton King is unique in terms of style?

Respondents rated Cotton King’s style differentiation on a scale from “Definitely No” (1) to “Definitely Yes” (5), as visualized below.



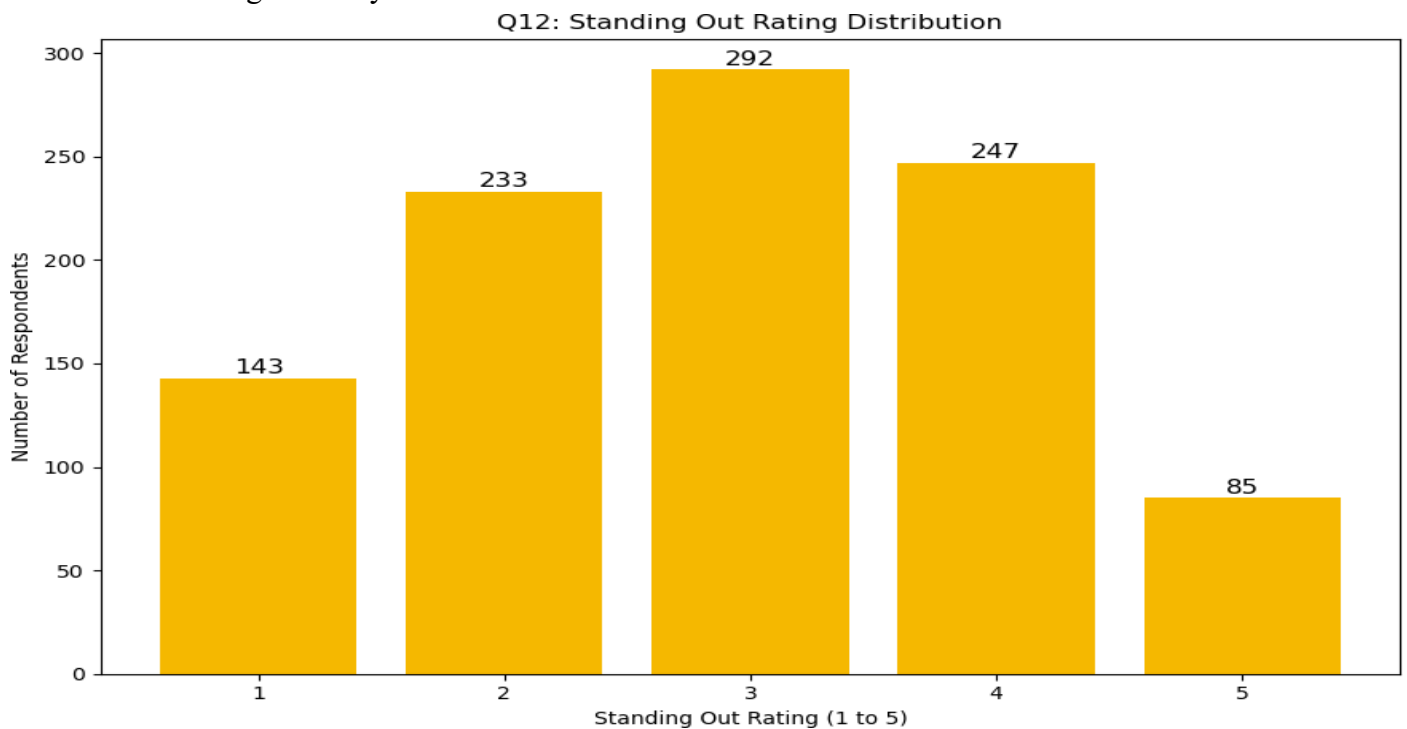
11. Do you think Cotton King is unique in terms of quality ?

This chart quantifies perceived uniqueness in product quality—a core strength for cotton-focused apparel brands.



12. Do you think Cotton King stands out as compared to other brands?

Standing out beyond category norms is key for brand equity, and this graphic shows where Cotton King currently ranks in overall market distinctiveness.



POWER GRID ANALYSIS

The DREK Brand Grid visually benchmarks Cotton King's position within the menswear market, mapping brand strength (differentiation & relevance) against brand stature (esteem & knowledge). Each quadrant represents a strategic archetype, providing insight into future potential, competitive risk, and market trajectory.

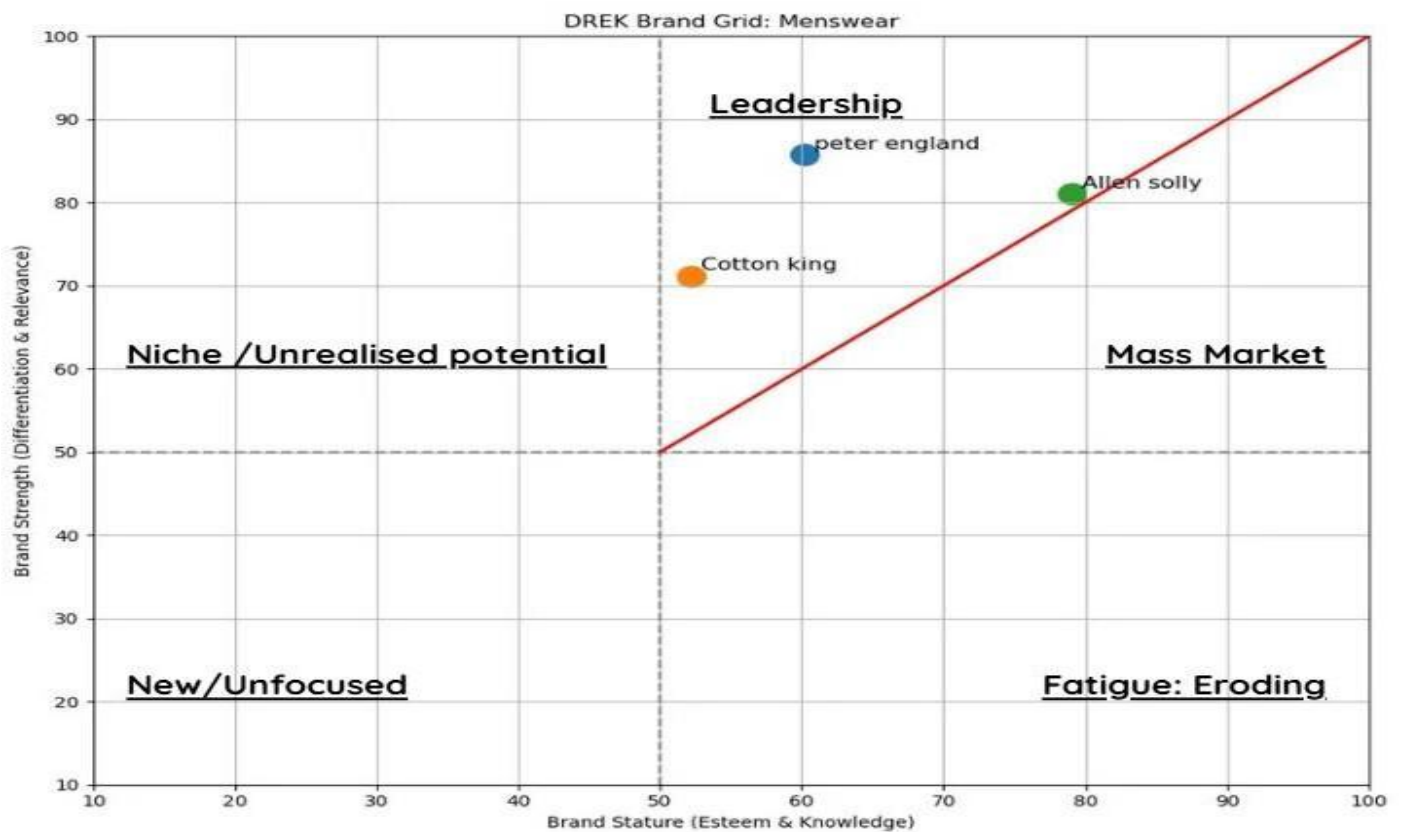
In 2021, Cotton King was positioned in the "Niche/Unrealised Potential" quadrant of the DREK Brand Grid. This indicated that while the brand had strong differentiation and relevance in its target segment, it lacked wider recognition and emotional appeal compared to larger menswear players. Its reach and consumer connection were more regional and functional rather than aspirational.

However, in the latest Power Grid (2025), Cotton King has shown a notable upward shift towards the "Leadership" quadrant. This progression reflects a clear improvement in both brand strength and consumer perception. Over the years, the brand has strengthened its market presence through consistent quality, strong product relevance, and improved awareness.

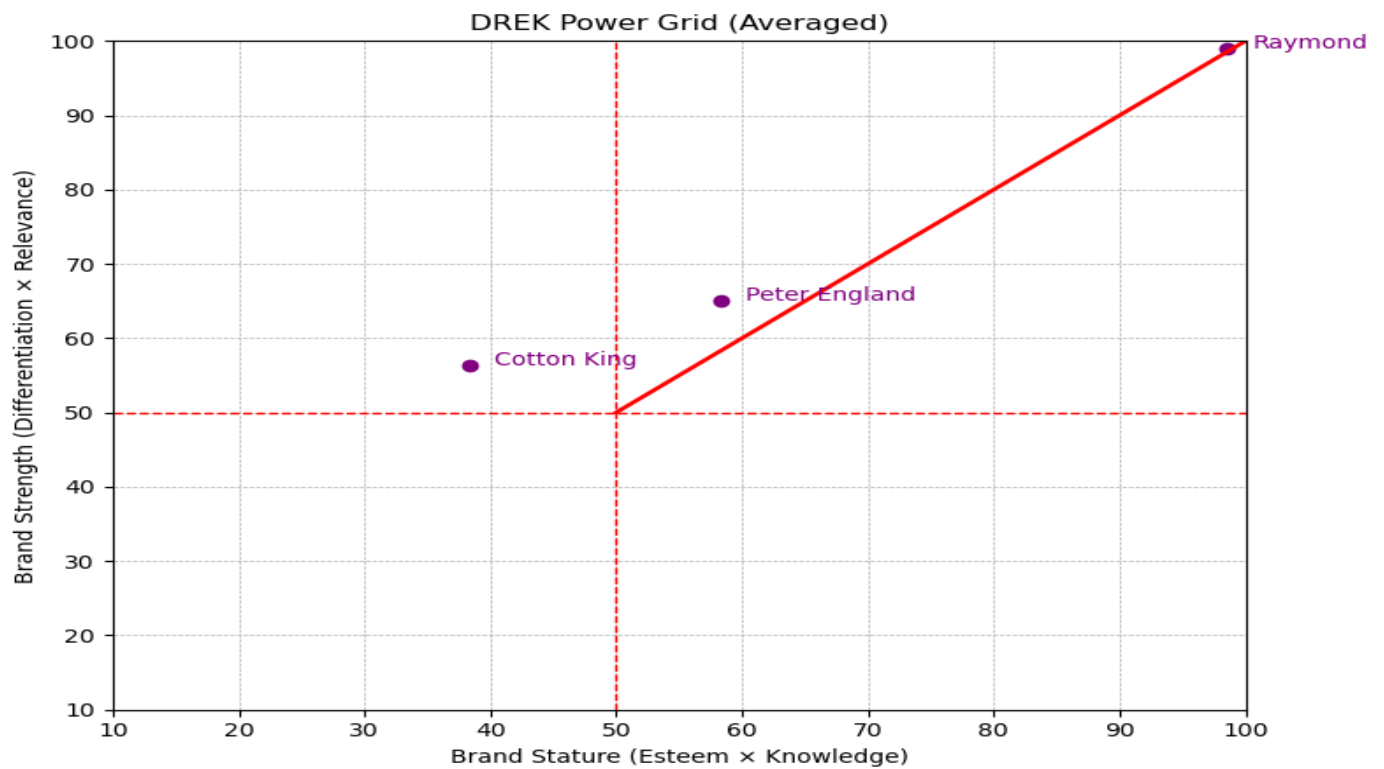
While Cotton King still trails behind its core competitors like Peter England and Allen Solly in terms of stature and aspirational appeal, its movement from a niche player to a leadership zone signifies a positive brand evolution — driven by better communication, customer trust, and a clear positioning around comfort and fabric excellence.

Overall, this transition highlights Cotton King's journey from regional recognition to emerging national relevance, marking it as a strong, credible brand with future growth potential in the menswear category.

POWER GRID 2025:



POWER GRID 2021:

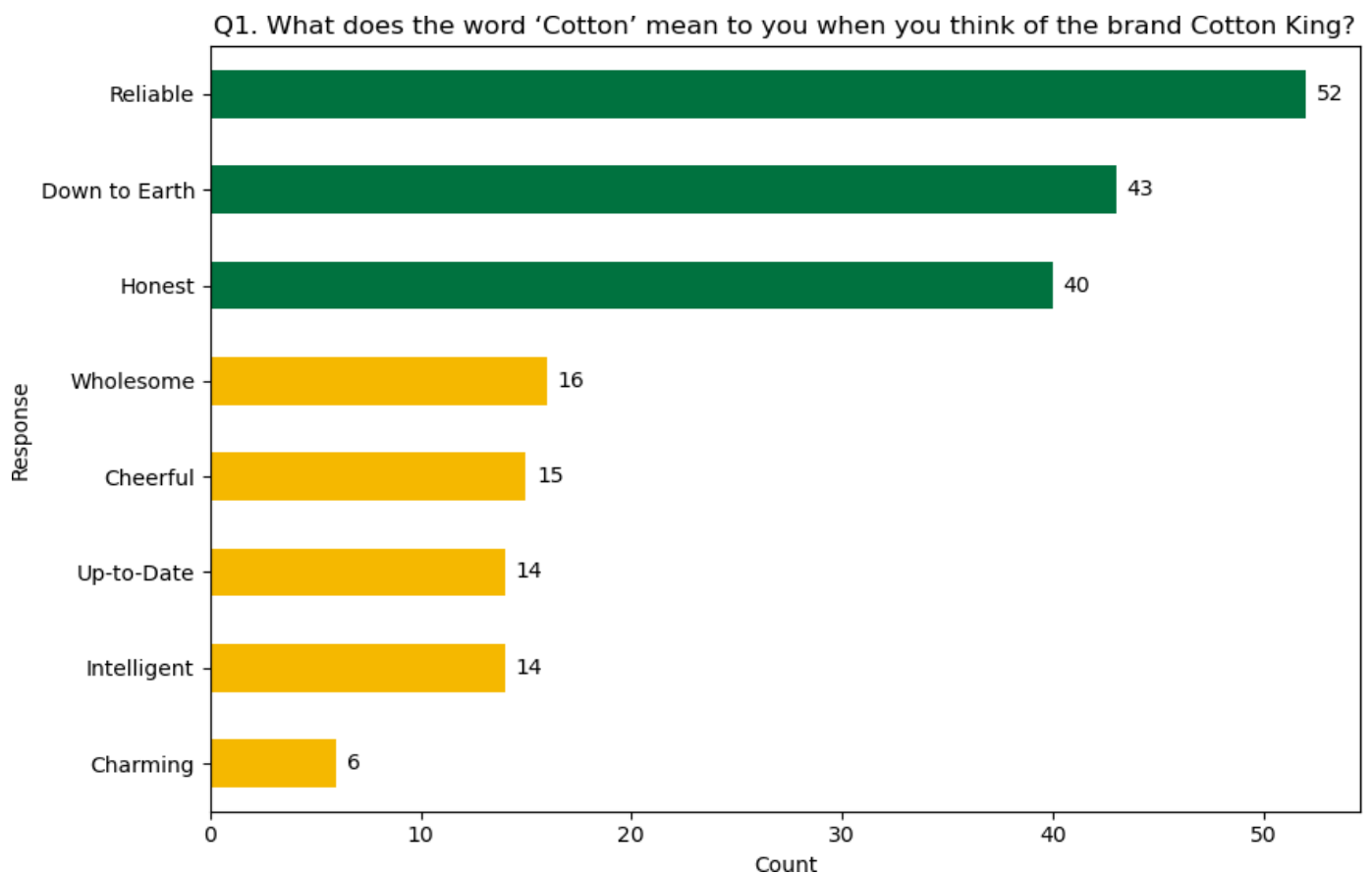


BRAND PERSONALITY

This section explores the emotional and symbolic attributes shaping Cotton King's persona in the eyes of consumers. Through targeted brand personality questions, the survey uncovers both the rational and aspirational qualities that define how Cotton King is perceived compared to key competitors.

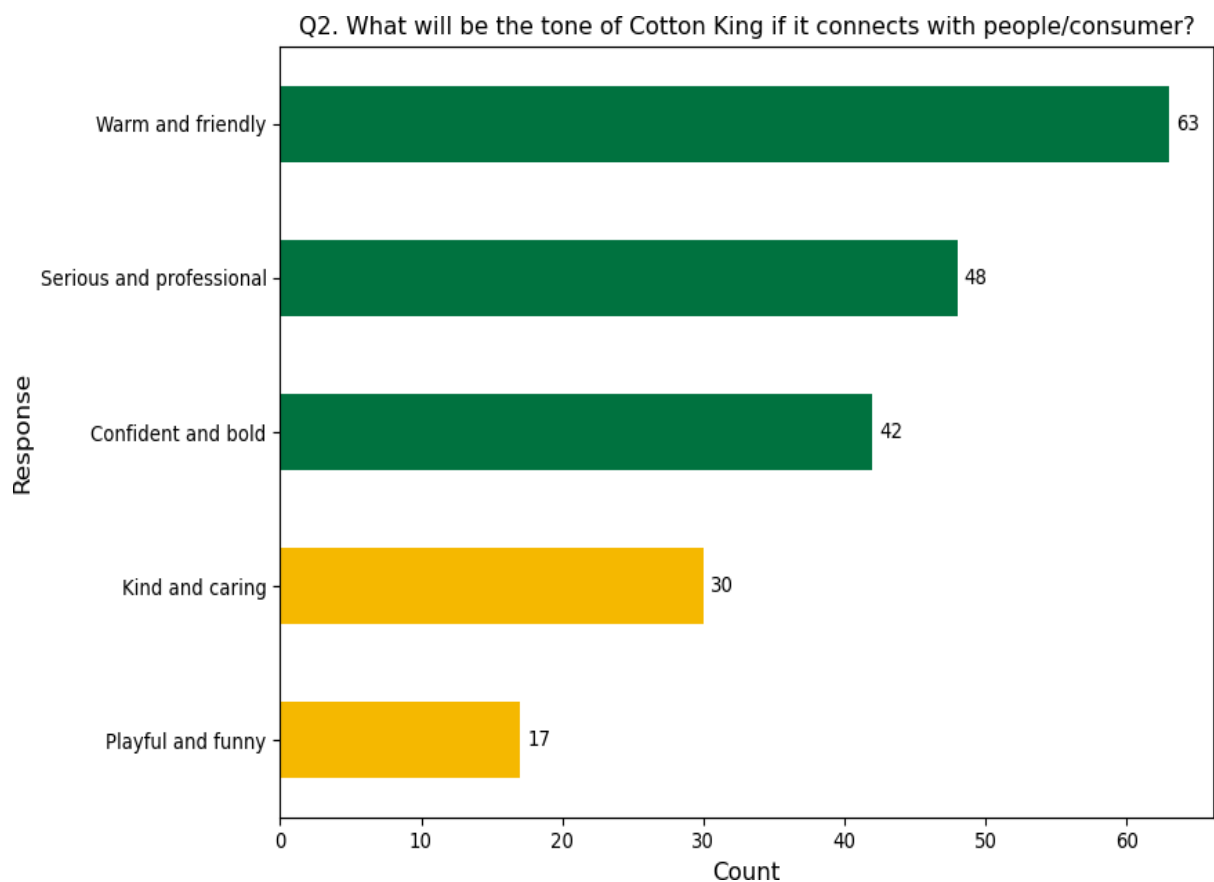
Q1. What does the word 'Cotton' mean to you when you think of the brand Cotton King?

Consumers primarily associate Cotton King with being “Reliable,” “Down to Earth,” and “Honest.” These attributes reflect a strong perception of trustworthiness and straightforwardness, aligning with the brand’s longstanding focus on dependable, quality cotton apparel.



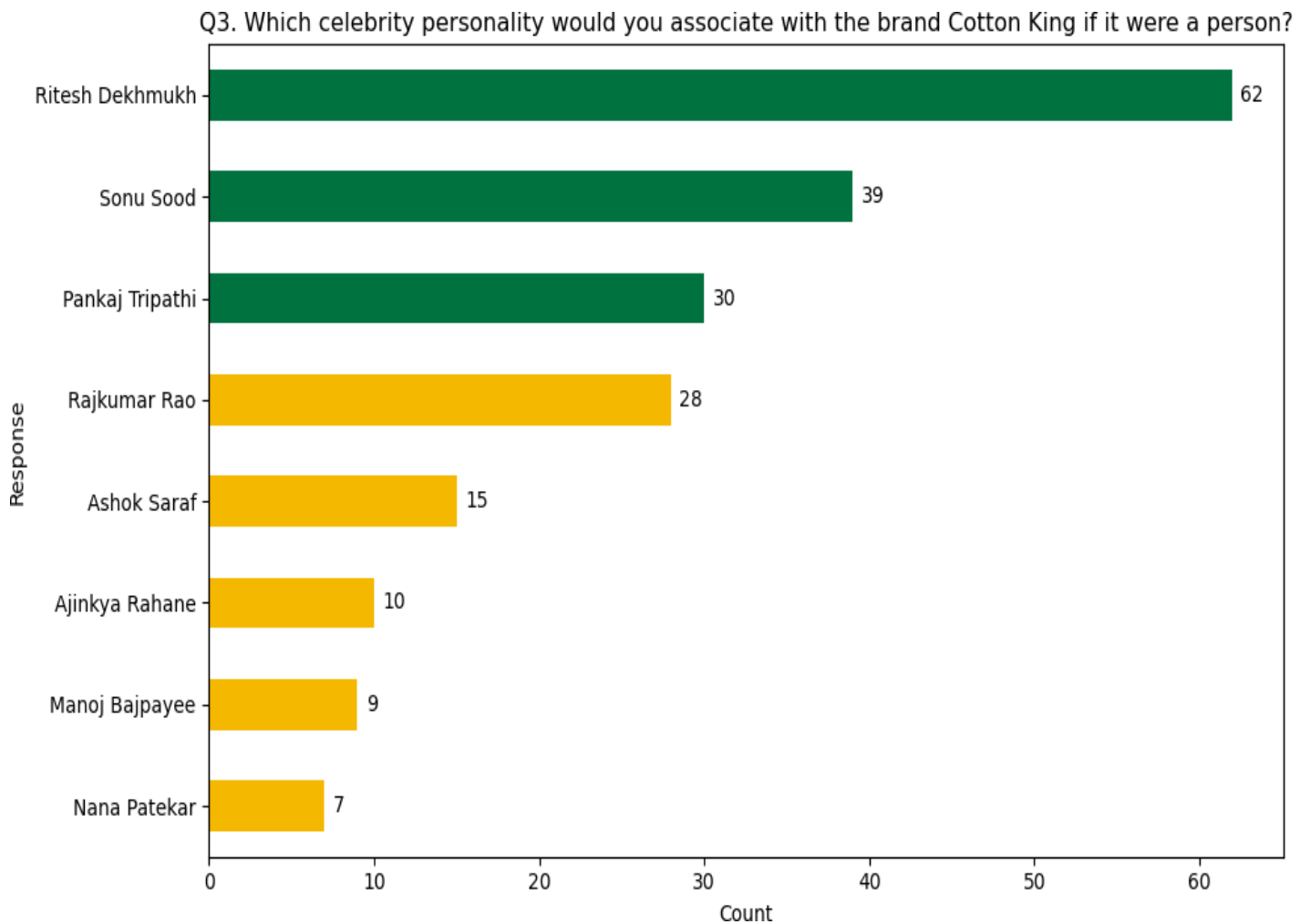
Q2. What will be the tone of Cotton King if it connects with people/consumer?

Survey respondents see Cotton King's tone as predominantly "Warm and friendly," with notable mentions of "Serious and professional" and "Confident and Bold." Brand warmth is essential for engagement and loyalty, especially in the apparel sector, while confidence and professionalism reinforce trust and credibility.



Q3. Which celebrity personality would you associate with the brand Cotton King if it were a person?

Ritesh Deshmukh emerges as the leading celebrity association, embodying a friendly, relatable, and down-to-earth personality. This mirrors Cotton King's perceived warmth, reliability, and approachable character, with additional associations to Sonu Sood and Pankaj Tripathi reinforcing the brand's positive image.



CONCLUSION TO THE STUDY, RECOMMENDATIONS, AND INSIGHTS

- Many consumers report that shirts lose colour and brightness after a few
- This is also observed in formal pants and jeans.
- The collar area of shirts often retains creases post-ironing

RECOMMENDATIONS AND STRATEGIC INSIGHTS:

Digital engagement: Significantly increase digital presence, storytelling, and customer service touchpoints—particularly for young buyers. Employ more interactive social platforms and after-sales follow-up initiatives.

CONCLUSION:

From 2021 to 2025, Cotton King has shown a clear improvement in its brand position. In 2021, it was in the “Niche/Unrealised Potential” quadrant, which meant the brand had good products and quality but was limited to a smaller, loyal customer base with less national recognition.

After four years, Cotton King has moved up to the “Leadership” quadrant, showing strong growth in both brand strength and customer trust. This shift means the brand has become more recognized, relevant, and respected in the market.

While Peter England and Allen Solly still lead in terms of popularity and aspirational image, Cotton King’s upward movement reflects real progress. It shows that the brand is no longer seen as just a regional player but is now emerging as a credible and trusted name in the men’s apparel market. This shift highlights Cotton King’s journey towards becoming a stronger, more visible, and more preferred brand among Indian consumers.